HOORVIA - FISH & SHELLFISH INTERNAL TEMPERATURE CHART (CHEF VS USDA)

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Kitchen & Cooking

Wild King / Sockeye Salmon			
Chef Pull Temp	**Chef Rested Target**	**USDA Safe Standard**	**Ideal Texture & Flake Cue**
120°F-122°F / 49°C	125°F / 52°C (Med-Rare)	145°F / 63°C	Silky, translucent coral center; zero white curd

Farmed Atlantic Salmon			
Chef Pull Temp	**Chef Rested Target**	**USDA Safe Standard**	**Ideal Texture & Flake Cue**
125°F-130°F / 52°C	130°F-135°F / 54°C (Med)	145°F / 63°C	Higher fat content stays buttery up to 135°F / 57°C

Sushi-Grade Ahi Tuna Steak			
Chef Pull Temp	**Chef Rested Target**	**USDA Safe Standard**	**Ideal Texture & Flake Cue**
110°F-115°F / 43°C	115°F / 46°C (Seared Rare)	145°F / 63°C (Dry!)	Sear 90 sec/side; ruby-red raw center

Swordfish / Mahi-Mahi Steak			
Chef Pull Temp	**Chef Rested Target**	**USDA Safe Standard**	**Ideal Texture & Flake Cue**
130°F-132°F / 55°C	135°F-138°F / 57°C	145°F / 63°C	Dense meaty steaks; pull before 140°F / 60°C or they dry

Halibut / Chilean Sea Bass			
Chef Pull Temp	**Chef Rested Target**	**USDA Safe Standard**	**Ideal Texture & Flake Cue**
128°F-132°F / 53°C	135°F / 57°C	145°F / 63°C	Large pearlescent flakes separate gently with fork

Cod / Haddock / Pollock Loin			
Chef Pull Temp	**Chef Rested Target**	**USDA Safe Standard**	**Ideal Texture & Flake Cue**
135°F-138°F / 57°C	140°F-145°F / 60°C-63°C	145°F / 63°C	Lean flaky white fish; turns opaque milk-white

Tilapia / Flounder / Sole			
Chef Pull Temp	**Chef Rested Target**	**USDA Safe Standard**	**Ideal Texture & Flake Cue**
138°F-140°F / 59°C	145°F / 63°C	145°F / 63°C	Thin fillets cook in 5-7 min; flakes easily

Whole Trout / Snapper / Branzino			
Chef Pull Temp	**Chef Rested Target**	**USDA Safe Standard**	**Ideal Texture & Flake Cue**
135°F / 57°C (At Bone)	140°F / 60°C	145°F / 63°C	Dorsal fin pulls out effortlessly when done

PRO TIP: If you order salmon or halibut at a fine-dining restaurant, the kitchen never cooks it to 145°F. Here is the science behind the 20°F gap between government guidelines and culinary standards: